

Unmapped Accounts

Test code

GL-011

Category

General Ledger

Logic version

1.0

Purpose and audit objective

Identify General Ledger transactions posted to account codes absent from the organisation's authoritative Chart of Accounts. The objective is to determine whether transactions use accounts defined in that reference dataset.

Why it matters

Unrecognised accounts may indicate configuration errors, unauthorised account creation, incorrect coding, migration or interface problems, master-data weaknesses, or financial reporting classification risk. An exception is a record requiring scrutiny; it does not establish fraud, error, non-compliance or a confirmed audit finding.

Required datasets and mapping

Primary role: **general_ledger** (General Ledger). Reference role: **chart_of_accounts** (Chart of Accounts). Both require the canonical field **account_code**, mapped to the relevant source column. No transaction-date mapping, threshold or discretionary parameter is required. Missing mappings, a missing reference dataset or ambiguous reference selection prevent execution through normal readiness checks.

Deterministic rule

Build a set of nonblank reference account keys. For each nonblank GL account, test whether the same key is in that set. If present, the GL record is not an exception; if absent, flag that GL record. Matching is exact membership after the normalisation described below. There is no fuzzy, substring or AI matching.

Account identity and normalisation

Use the original loaded value exposed by the mapped field, trim surrounding whitespace and compare case-insensitively. Text is not numerically coerced. Leading zeros and punctuation are retained: **00120 differs from 120**, and **A-B differs from AB**. Native finite numbers are compared using their loaded text representation; the procedure does not infer numeric equivalence. Source formatting or leading zeros already lost before loading cannot be reconstructed.

Counts, evidence and limits

Blank and duplicate accounts

Blank/null GL account codes are excluded from evaluation, not classified as unmapped. Blank/null COA codes are ignored. Duplicate COA keys are collapsed to one membership key; they neither multiply GL exceptions nor block otherwise valid existence testing. Their counts are reported as reference metrics. Duplicate reference count means rows beyond the first occurrence of each normalised key.

What the exception count represents

The exception population contains **GL transaction records**, not COA records or unique account codes. If absent account 9999 is used by 30 GL records, the exception count is 30 and the unique unmapped account count is 1. Reconciliation: population = evaluated + excluded; exception count cannot exceed evaluated count. Exception rate = exceptions / evaluated records x 100, or zero when nothing is evaluated.

Evidence and supporting metrics

Each exception retains its GL source record ID, source row number, original account value and normalised matching key. Dataset identity, source SHA-256, combined dataset-mapping fingerprint, procedure version, effective parameters and execution metadata remain in the standard result/report context. Supporting metrics identify the reference dataset, distinct reference keys, distinct unmapped keys, and blank/duplicate reference rows.

Scope and limitations

The full prepared GL population is used. The recorded audit period does **not** filter GL011 transactions. Existence alone is tested: inactive, blocked, closed, disabled or unused accounts that appear in the COA are not unmapped accounts. GL011 does not test account status, account authorisation, classification or whether an account is appropriate for a particular transaction.

Reference quality and failed runs

Confirm the COA's authority and completeness. At least one usable nonblank account identifier is required; otherwise GL011 fails safely, returning no result or exceptions. Text and finite numeric identifiers are supported. Unresolvable fields or unsupported values such as booleans, dates or non-finite numbers fail execution clearly rather than produce a misleading result. Cancellation uses the application's normal cooperative cancellation mechanism.

Suggested auditor response

Validate the reference extract, investigate the affected GL records and trace exceptions back to source evidence. Assess explanations and corroborating records before deciding whether an audit finding is warranted. Missing GL account values and account-status restrictions are separate review conditions.